



IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 43: Conference Presentations

Part II

Prof. Binod Mishra

DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES



Conference Presentations

A **CONFERENCE** is a formal meeting for consultation and discussion on ideas or problems pertaining to a specific subject or topic

PURPOSE

- ✓ To communicate the importance of your research
- ✓ A platform to receive feedback



SIGNIFICANCE

- Build network with people in your field of study
- Get exposed to experts and professionals

APPLICATIONS

- Academic conferences
- Professional pitch meetings
- Entrepreneurial conferences

Preparations for Conference Presentations

- ❑ A polished and professional conference presentation, like any other public speaking exercise, comprises a **thorough preparation** and an **emphatic delivery**.
- ✓ The checklist of preparation for conferences includes answers to the following questions:

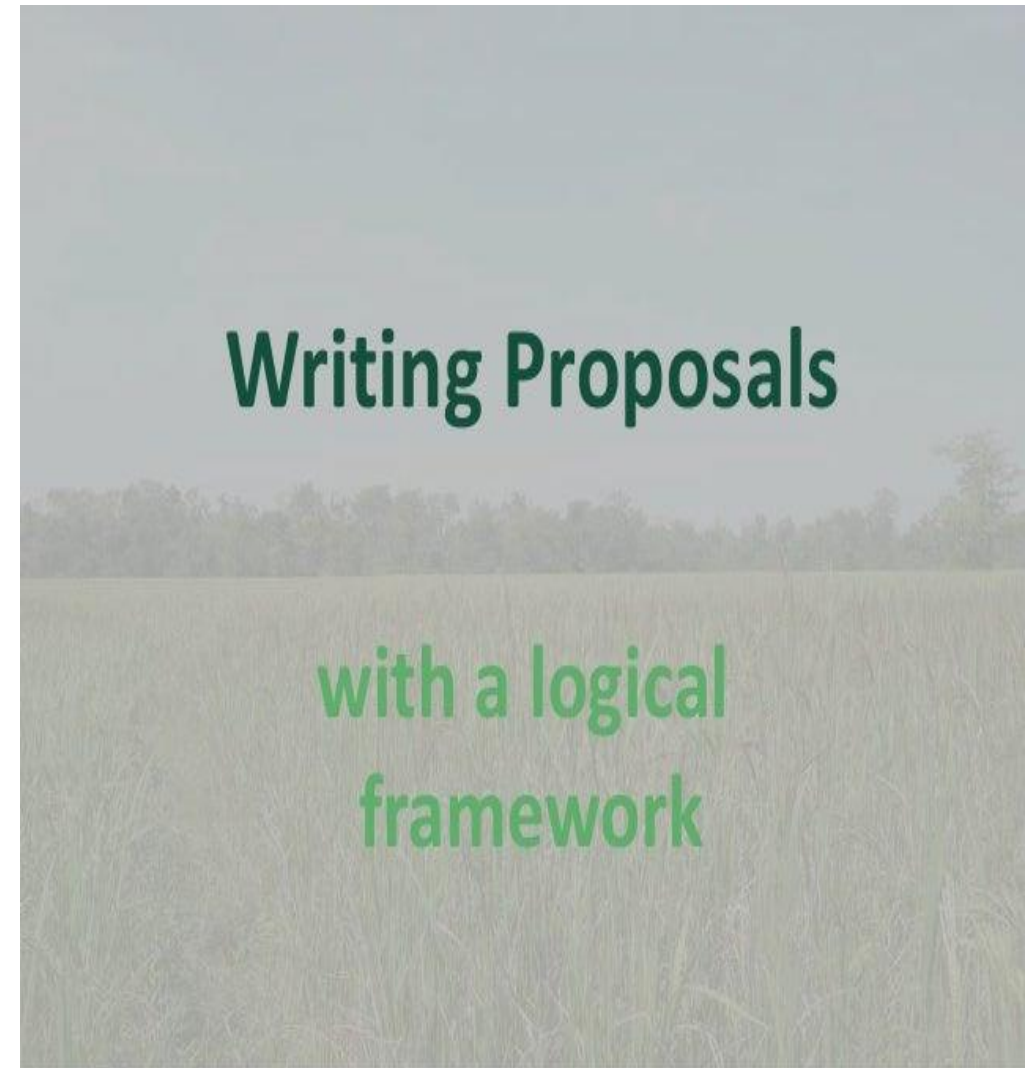
- ✓ What is the main aim of the conference?
- ✓ Is your theme aligned with the broader scope of the conference?
- ✓ What is the knowledge level and expectations of the audience?
- ✓ What is the most effective way to communicate your ideas through this platform?
- ✓ How much time is allotted for the presentation of your ideas?
- ✓ What new information or awareness do you plan as takeaways for your audience?

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01	PURPOSE	• Outline your primary purpose to inform, to discuss, or to demonstrate
02	AUDIENCE	• Their knowledge and comprehension • Their concentration span • Their expectations - intellectual, practical, personal
03	STRUCTURE	• The content - what to include and otherwise • Organizing the content • Prioritising the leads
04	COMMUNICATION AIDS	• Arranging for aids like data projector and whiteboard • Familiarising one self with their operation and functioning

Designing Smart Conference Proposals

- ☐ Ensure your topic is relevant to the theme of the conference. Avoid a narrow topic.
- ☐ Follow the guidelines of the submission.
- ☐ Introduce your idea with a catchy and interesting title to rivet the attention.
- ☐ Write a concise and clear abstract stating your key points up front.
- ☐ Proof-read your write-up multiple times to avoid any grammatical errors.
- ☐ Remember to submit well in advance before the deadline.



Types of Proposals

Internal- Written to someone within your organization

or

External- Written to someone outside your organization

Solicited- Intended reader has asked for proposals or ideas

or

Unsolicited- Intended reader has not asked for proposals or ideas

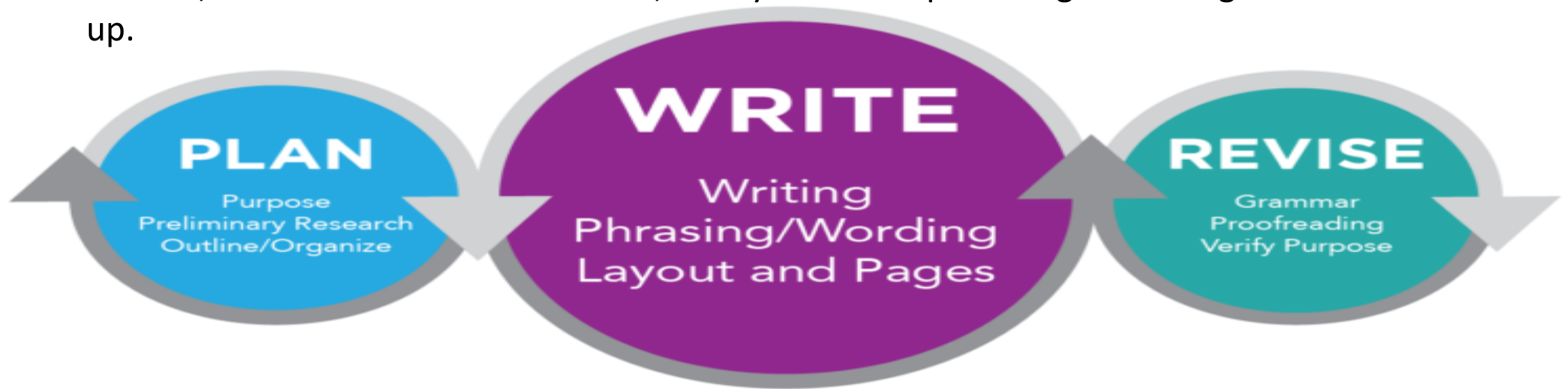
Unknown Solution- A problem is identified; research will be conducted to find a solution

or

Known Solution- Writer has an idea to implement; research will be conducted to check feasibility

Planning your Paper

- ❑ The presentation ought to be brief ; the **complex ideas** feature in your paper. Thus, presentation can be thought **as a key to your detailed paper**.
- ❑ Plan the **first draft** of your paper considering the aim of your presentation, the intended audience, and the time allotted for the talk.
- ❑ **Review, revise** and **edit** the first draft, until you come up with a good enough version of the write-up.

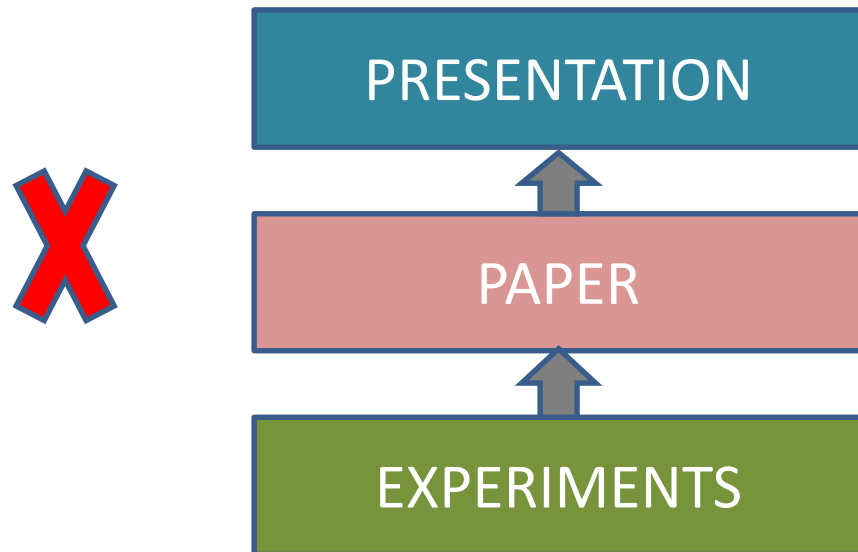


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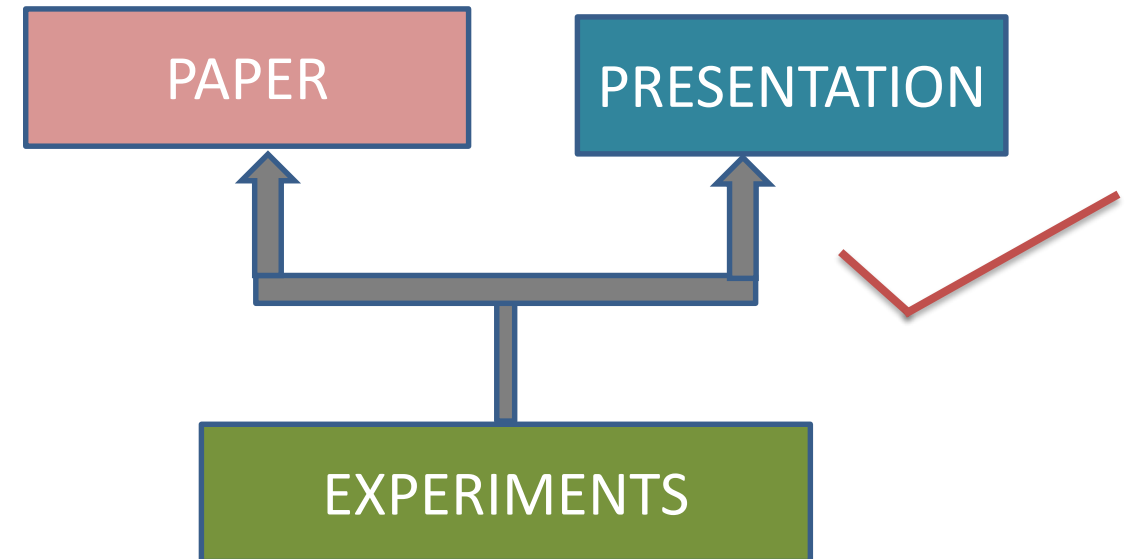
The **conference presentation is different from the research paper** in the following terms:

- ❑ It is much **simpler** –it communicates the complex ideas and the findings of the paper in a simplified manner.
- ❑ It is **more exciting** as it ought to contain the best parts of your paper and reserves the tedious ones for a detailed reading.

The presentation is not derived from the paper



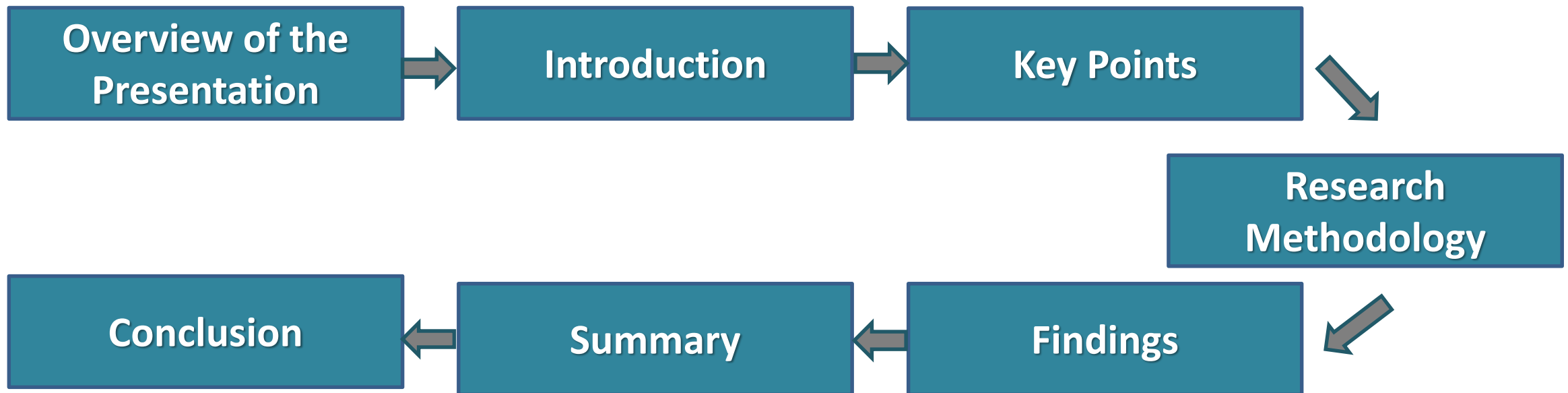
Rather, it is derived from the work



Designing your Presentation: The Structure

- ❑ While designing the structure of your presentation, pay attention to:
 - The objective of your presentation
 - The compatibility of technological aids
 - The factor of time allotment

The general pattern for structuring a conference presentation may look as follows:



Designing Your Presentation: The Content

- ❑ **The First Page:** It should include the title of your paper, author, affiliation and venue. Check for any template/styles recommended exclusively for use in the particular conference.
- ❑ **Message:** Do not overcrowd your slides with tedious information. Keep the font size readable. Maintain consistency in using colour combinations.
- ❑ **Stick to the *Rule of Five*:** To attain clarity and focus in your argument, ensure that you do not use more than five main points in a slide.
- ❑ **Graphics, Pictures and Animations:** Relieve boredom by incorporating graphics and animations in an appropriate manner. Right goes the adage – ***A picture is worth a thousand words***. Also, avoid populating your slides with too many graphics or effects, as it will distract the audience.

Designing Your Presentation: The Content

Text –

- ✓ Use short Bullet Points.
- ✓ Follow the **6*6 norm**:
- ✓ 6 bullets in a slide; 6 words in each bullet.

- ✓ Highlight important points.
- ✓ Be concise on the topic.
- ✓ Use diagrams, graphs, equations, tables judiciously.

- ✓ Summarise at the end and also mid-way to keep audience on track.

- Decide your '**bottom line**':
Identify the main point of your conference, and relate to your previous arguments in order to reach the conclusion

- ✓ Divide the content into sections, each slide dealing with one key idea.
- ✓ Sections should flow seamlessly.

Designing the Slides



- ☐ Plan the **number of slides** according to the timing of presentation – about one slide per minute
- ☐ Choose a **clear and legible font**, such as Arial, Calibri, Times New Roman, or Helvetica.
- ☐ The font size should vary ideally **between 20 to 36** – 36 point for titles and 28 point for body text.
- ☐ **Maintain consistency** – Stick to a uniform font style and size throughout the slide.
- ☐ Prefer a dark colour for the background and light colour for the text, or vice versa, to **keep up the contrast**.
- ☐ Be very attentive to **spelling mistakes**, grammatical errors and wrong punctuations.
- ☐ Prefer **bold** over underline to **emphasize key points**.

Designing The Slides – Sample



Use of Visual Aids: Significance

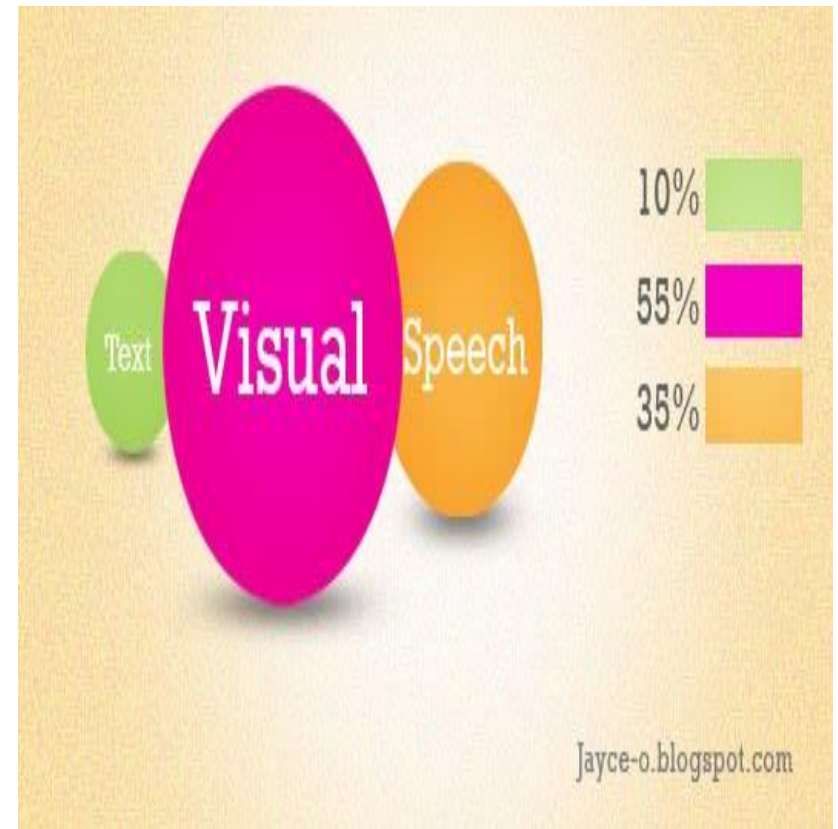
- ❖ Visual aids (images and graphs) help audiences to understand the idea in a better manner.
- ❖ As per research findings, after two days of the presentation, audience can retain only 7% of what they read, whereas 55% of what they saw in pictorial form.
- ❖ They alleviate the pressure on the speaker as audience's eyes are on the visuals for some time.



- ❖ Images should be large enough, clear and of high-resolution.
- ❖ Do not add visual aids unless relevant or necessary.
- ❖ Prefer simpler graphs and charts. Caption images with titles.
- ❖ Mention copyright information wherever applicable.

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- ✓ **STIMULATES INTEREST:** Speech engages the auditory sense and images appeal to the **visual sense** of the audience. Delivering the content in a variety of formats stimulates listeners' cognitive ability and thereby keeps them active and interested throughout.
- ✓ **SAVES TIME:** *"A picture paints a thousand words."* Relevant visual aids like graphs can cover significant amount of content in a short duration of time.
- ✓ **CREATES IMPACT:** Visuals create a stronger and lasting impact on the receiver's mind. Visual aids (like a supporting quotation, or an illustrative image) can be intelligently employed to drive home a crucial idea, to generate discussions, and to create a memorable impression.



Timing the Presentation

- Fit the presentation strictly into the time allocated – **Set realistic timing** by rehearsing the presentation beforehand.
- Choose to deliver **less content at a reasonable pace**.
- Ideally, one should **spend 1 – 2 minutes per slide**.
- Categorise the parts you need to discuss and those which **can be covered via handouts/visuals aids**.
- Reserve time for **breaks, asides, questions, discussion** and to receive constructive criticism/ feedback.
- Take into consideration the chances of **time–overrun of the previous presentations**, and be prepared to tailor your talk accordingly.

Parts of the Presentation	Share of the Timing
Background Outline Significance Problem / Question	10 – 25%
Methods Discussion Result	60 – 80%
Summation Limitations Future Scope Practical Import	10 – 15%

Effective Use of Power Point

- ❑ **Review your slides:** Ensure that you re-check your slides before the final presentation to correct inadvertent errors of spelling or formatting. Don't forget to save the corrections.
- ❑ **Co-ordinate the slides with your talk:** Rehearse your talk with PowerPoint beforehand, so that you are well versed with the order and time of appearance of slides during your talk. Project a slide only at the time when you are discussing the point it illustrates.
- ❑ **Check the gadgets:** Check the functionality of the equipments at the venue and their compatibility. Familiarize yourself with the set-up well in advance before your talk begins.
- ❑ **Be informed of Slide Show Commands:** In PowerPoint 2007
 - To show the next slide – press Enter key/ the right arrow button/ the “N” key
 - To go to the previous slide – press backspace/ the left arrow button/the “P” key
 - To present a specific slide – Type the slide number and press Enter key
 - To end the slide show – press Esc key.

Marketing your Conference

- As per the survey reports of Eventbrite, **around 25%** of all registrations to an event are stimulated by their social media promotions.
- Create a **conference social handle**, for example on Instagram or on Twitter. Share therein the registration link, information about the speakers and the attendees, lively photos or memes which resonate with the event.
- Design **simple and catchy hashtags**. For e.g. - *#academiaconf2022*. Post, share and repost.
- Continue with the promotional activities **before, during, as well as after the end** of the conference to keep up the buzz.



Tips for Successful Conference Strategy

PRE-CONFERENCE

- ❖ Expand awareness about the event.
- ❖ Focus on media outreach.
- ❖ Plan out the execution – the roles and responsibilities.
- ❖ Schedule appointments well in advance.

DURING CONFERENCE (Organizers)

- Keep a pilot eye on the smooth running of the event.
- Use social media (like live blogs and tweets) to buzz interest.

DURING CONFERENCE (Participants)

- Avoid any last minute changes in your presentation.
- Be attentive to other participants' speeches.
- Keep calm and enjoy the sessions.

POST-CONFERENCE

- ✓ Review the event with your team.
- ✓ Share the learnings of the conference.
- ✓ Give honest feedback.
- ✓ Highlight the contributions of the individuals and thank them.

*Reading maketh a full man;
conference a ready man; and
writing an exact man.*
- Francis Bacon

Thank You!

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